

Art for Shelter

A benefit art exhibition and auction

For



By



A Study in Generosity

Post-Auction Impact Analysis Report prepared on 13 November 2025

Art for Shelter

Art for Shelter auction is born from a simple yet profound idea that art, when shared for a cause greater than itself, has the power to rebuild lives. The vision to generate funds for Habitat for Humanity through an inclusive, accessible art platform reflects a belief that creativity and compassion can coexist in the most tangible ways. The auction presents a curated collection that is intimate in scale yet expansive in spirit. It brings together works that traverse materials, geographies, and generations from the luminous warmth of brass metal pieces and the intricate storytelling of traditional Indian paintings to limited-edition digital artworks. Each artwork, whether crafted by a senior artist or an emerging talent, embodies a shared ethos of care, generosity, and continuity. What makes Art for Shelter distinctive is its embrace of the humble and the collectible alike. The initiative opens the act of giving to a wider circle inviting not only seasoned collectors but also first-time art buyers to participate in building change. Here, every bid becomes a gesture of solidarity, transforming artistic expression into shelter, and aesthetic appreciation into a promise of dignity for those in need. Beyond its charitable intent, this initiative redefines the role of art in society not merely as an object to be admired, but as an instrument of community, dialogue, and hope. The creative contributions gathered here form a chorus of compassion, reminding us that the true value of art lies in its ability to connect, uplift, and heal.

Art for Shelter celebrates a new kind of patronage one rooted not in possession, but in participation. It reminds us that while homes are built with bricks and beams, it is empathy and imagination that build the foundations of humanity itself.

In building homes, we build hope. And through art, we create belonging, a world where every gesture of creation shelters a deeper sense of togetherness.

Habitat For Humanity India

Driven by the vision that everyone needs a decent place to live, Habitat for Humanity India began in 1983 as a grassroots effort. The housing organisation has since grown to become a leading housing nonprofit that has helped over tens of thousands of families in India build or improve a place they can call home. Through its housing, WASH (Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene) and housing disaster resilience and response programmes, Habitat for Humanity India has positively impacted the lives of over 7.7 millions of people across the country. Through financial support, volunteering or adding a voice to support affordable housing, everyone can help families achieve the strength, stability and self-reliance they need to build better lives for themselves. Through shelter, we empower. To learn more, donate or volunteer, visit www.habitatindia.org

The Histare Group

A pioneering cultural arts organization, The Histare group is committed to empowering communities, protecting the environment and celebrating India's rich and diverse heritage. The Histare group revives the esteemed legacy of "Roshan Lal Sita Ram", which was established in the 1930s by the family of Late Smt. Roop Rani Seth Vadehra and Late Shri. Sita Ram Vadehra. Founded by Late Smt. Simran Wahi Vadehra, the organisation is now led by Artistic Director and Philatelist Akhil Vadehra, in the fourth generation of his family's entrepreneurial traditions. Histare is dedicated to philanthropy and social impact by supporting causes that transform lives.

The Gesture Behind the Act

Art for Shelter emerged as an act of convergence — between art and empathy, creativity and cause.

Conceived by Histare in collaboration with Habitat for Humanity India, the project reimaged the art auction as a space of social dialogue — where artistic value became a direct instrument for humanitarian transformation.

15 artworks, gifted by artists and Histare, formed the foundation of this collective gesture — an exhibition and silent auction whose purpose transcended commerce, aligning instead with Habitat's mission to build homes, communities, and hope.

What We Set Out to Build

To raise funds for Habitat through a donor-driven silent auction; to broaden access to philanthropic giving through art; and to showcase the intersection of craft and contemporary practice in service of measurable social impact.

Structure in Essence

Benefit exhibition featuring a silent auction, where bids were recorded manually via contribution catalogues.

Revelations in Observation

The final confirmed contributions, together realising ₹472,000 against a reserve value of ₹138,788, reflecting an average gain of **240%**

An outcome that embodies both generosity and belief.

Artwork Title	Artist / Artisan	Reserve Price (₹)	Highest Bid (₹)	Winning Bidder	Premium (₹)
Whisper of the Moon	Khairunnissa Furniturewala	13,000	20,000	Mr. Shirish Jain	7,000
Gentle Protection	Khairunnissa Furniturewala	6,500	7,000	Mr. Ashish Nangia	500
Home Grown: A Living Map of Hope	Meenakshi Setia	54,288	207,000	Mrs. Swarnalatha Ramakrishnan	152,712
Flowers Mat	Suresh Kumar M	36,400	207,000	Mrs. Swarnalatha Ramakrishnan	170,600
Untitled	Dr. Gurcharan Singh	28,600	31,000	Mr. Harmeet Sahney	2,400

Art for Shelter marked the sale of **one-third** of the collection at a near threefold appreciation over reserve, underscoring the resonance of purpose-led patronage.

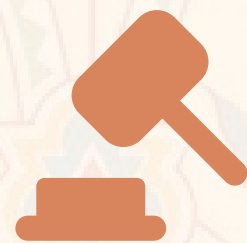
Encoded Particulars

Benefit exhibition featuring a silent auction, where bids were recorded manually via contribution catalogues.



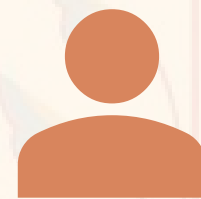
15

Total Artworks
Auctioned



5

Lots with
Final Bids



8

Participating
Contributors



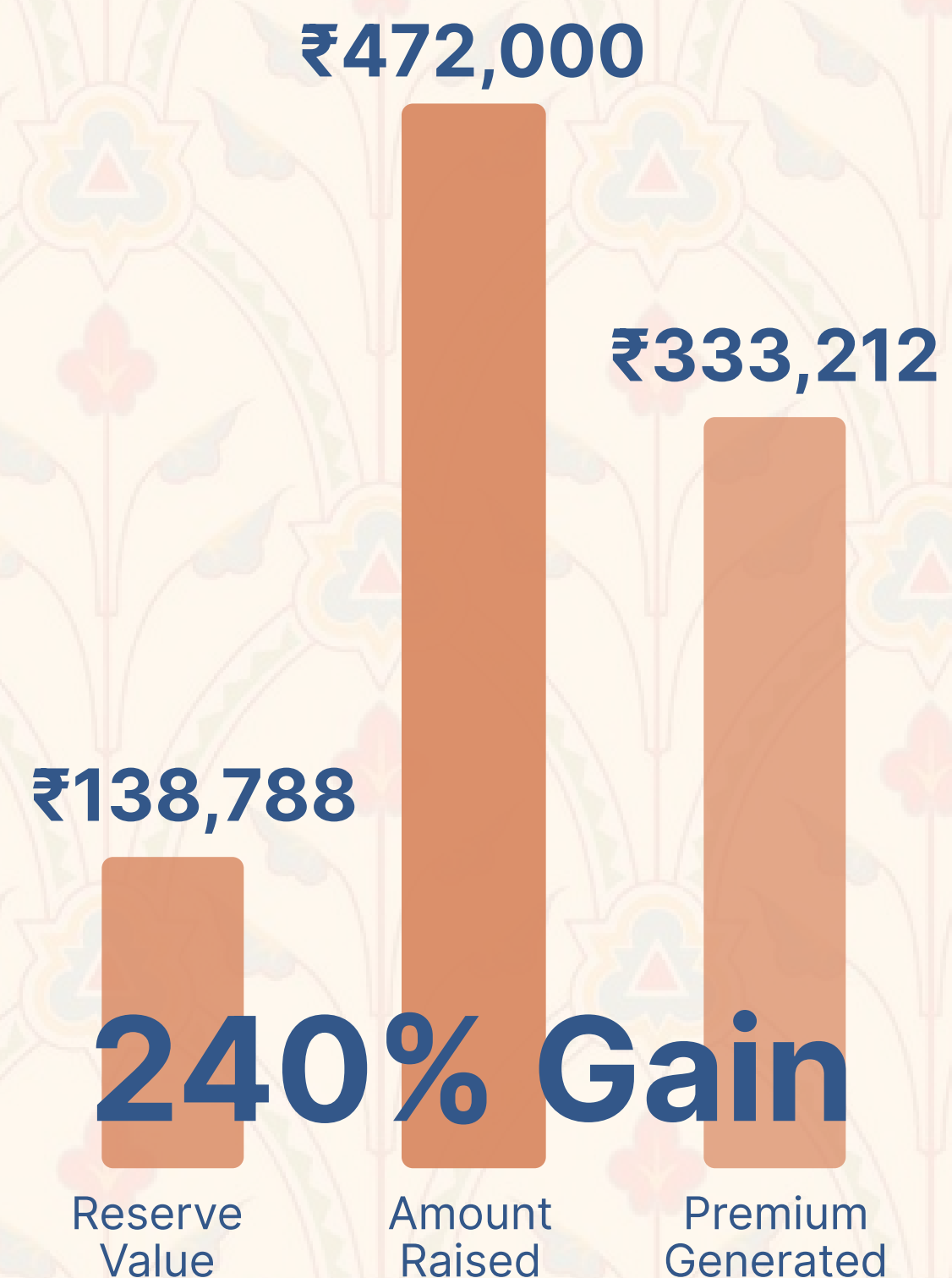
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Works
Exceeded by 2x



₹414,000

Highest Grossing Bidder :
**Mrs. Swarnalatha
Ramakrishnan**



The Art for Shelter collection became a meeting ground between contemporary and craft practices — a space where painting, textile, wood inlay, and sculpture spoke the language of resilience, belonging, and renewal.

Emergent Realizations

Two top-value works (Home Grown: A Living Map of Hope and Flowers Mat) contributed **₹414,000** — forming nearly **88%** of the total funds raised.

Buyers included both philanthropic patrons and art collectors, underscoring art's power to inspire social change.

Exceptional engagement with multiple artworks exceeding reserve prices — notably, **2** that achieved winning bids of **₹207,000** each.

A focused, high-impact collection that attracted both established collectors and first-time philanthropic art buyers.

Strengthened collaboration between Histare and Habitat for Humanity India, exemplifying how creativity and compassion can coexist in tangible, impactful ways.

Mediations of Display

Curated by Dr. Rikimi Madhukalliya, the exhibition presented art not as an isolated object but as an instrument of empathy.

The works reflected the continuum of material and meaning — where process, heritage, and narrative intersected with the idea of home.

Through form and gesture, the collection asked a simple question: Can art build shelter? — and responded by proving that it can.

Practitioners of Form

Meenakshi Setia, Chanchal Chakrobarty, Suresh Kumar M (artisan), Arunima Sanyal, Santosh Jain, Jitendra Thorat, Anaushka Rao, Samiksha Somani, Pallavi Nath, Toral Pandya, Girish Paramar, Dr. Gurcharan Singh, and Khairunnissa Furniturewala.

Echoes of Change

The proceeds from the auction will directly support Habitat for Humanity India's mission, transforming artistic intent into tangible impact.

The model's success invites replication — a touring annual edition envisioned to travel to new cities, collectors, and contexts, expanding both reach and relevance.

Future iterations will translate contributions into measurable "Funds-to-Houses" metrics — allowing donors to see, in bricks and beams, the living outcome of creative generosity.

Sustained Momentum

Histare and Habitat envision Art for Shelter as a sustained platform — evolving from a singular event into a movement where art becomes a vehicle for social equity.

Emerging initiatives include:

Art Funds and Collection Drives to seed new philanthropic models

Artist and Artisan Residencies that link making with meaning

Corporate Art Collaborations and “Adopt an Artwork” programmes that integrate CSR with culture

Community Art Drives that democratize ownership and engagement

Custodial Resolution

All artworks were donated by Histare and participating artists to Habitat for Humanity India Trust under Article 33 (Gift) via duly stamped Gift Deeds.

Ownership of 15 artworks was transferred to Habitat for Humanity India on 7 November 2025, for the purpose of the Art for Shelter auction at Sofitel BKC, Mumbai.

All reserve prices included taxes, packaging, and professional fees.

Unsold works remain under Habitat's custodianship and may be re-offered in future exhibitions or benefit auctions.

All proceeds shall be directed toward Habitat for Humanity India's charitable programmes.

Join us in building homes through Art



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